Figure 7.2 Web3 packages and structure

The web3 API lets you use the web3 class provided by the web3.js library and all its subclasses. It allows you to communicate with the local node through the RPC port. It also provides access to the `eth` object and its functions via `web3.eth` and network objects, via `web3.net` and its functions. You get the idea.

It is necessary to understand how web3 (of blockchain) works as you learn to develop blockchain applications at various levels. Figure 7.3, an enhanced version of figure 7.1, shows the use of web3 in an application. In the figure, the web3 provider implements the web3 API. The app.js of the application uses this web3 provider's function calls to access and interact with the underlying blockchain client node. The figure also shows the relationship of the client node with the blockchain network. The blockchain network connects many client nodes, such as the one shown in figure 7.3.

